

# Five Stories from Ancient Egypt

Long, long ago, people in Egypt told stories about their gods.
Here are five of the best ones.

## Meet the gods



**Ra**
say: RAH
God of the sun



**Nut**
say: NOOT
Goddess of the sky



**Geb**
say: GEB
God of the earth



**Osiris**
say: oh-SY-ris
The good king



**Isis**
say: EYE-sis
Goddess of magic and love



**Set**
say: SET
God of storms and the desert



**Horus**
say: HOR-us
God of the sky and kings



**Thoth**
say: THOTH
God of writing and clever ideas



**Anubis**
say: ah-NOO-bis
The helper with a jackal head

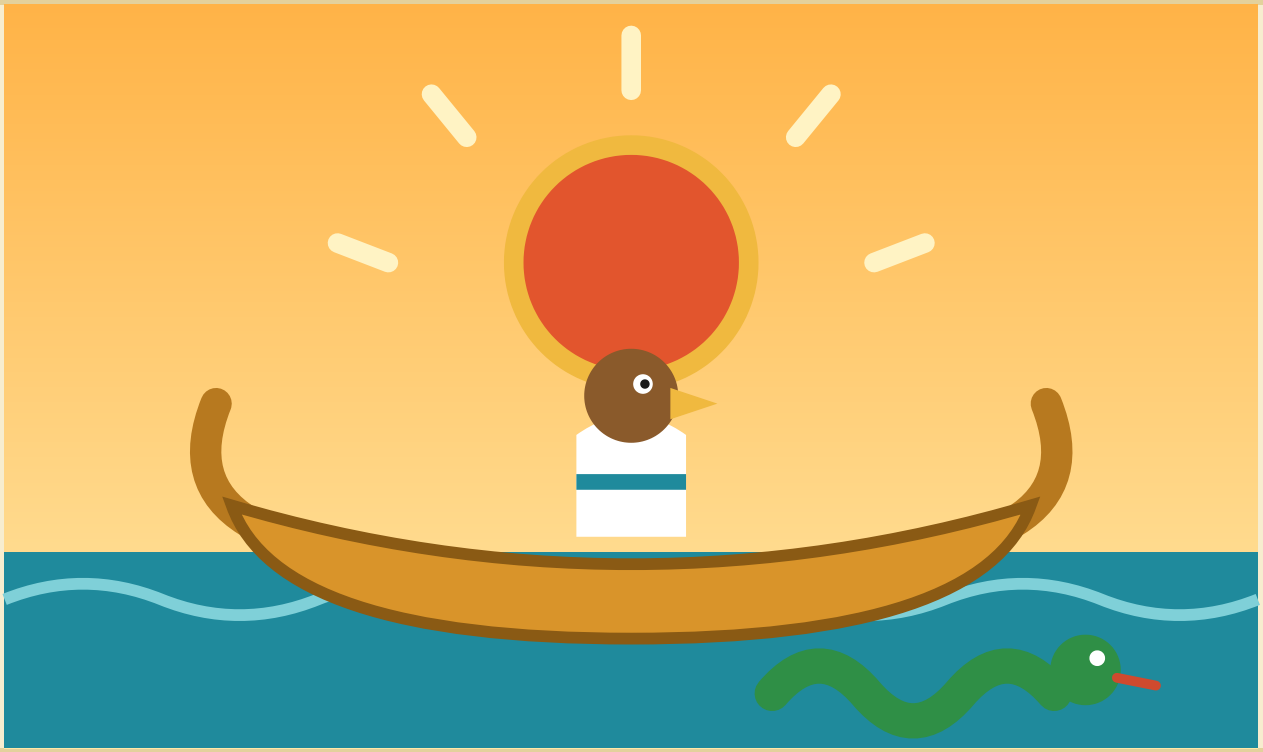


**Ma'at**
say: mah-AHT
Goddess of truth

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**For grown-ups:** These myths were told for more than 3,000 years and exist in many versions. The tellings here are shortened and softened for a six-year-old. The fights between Horus and Set and the fate of Osiris are much darker in the old texts.

# 1 Ra and the Sun Boat



In the very beginning, there was only dark water. Then **Ra**, the sun god, rose up and made light. He made the land, the plants, the animals and the people.

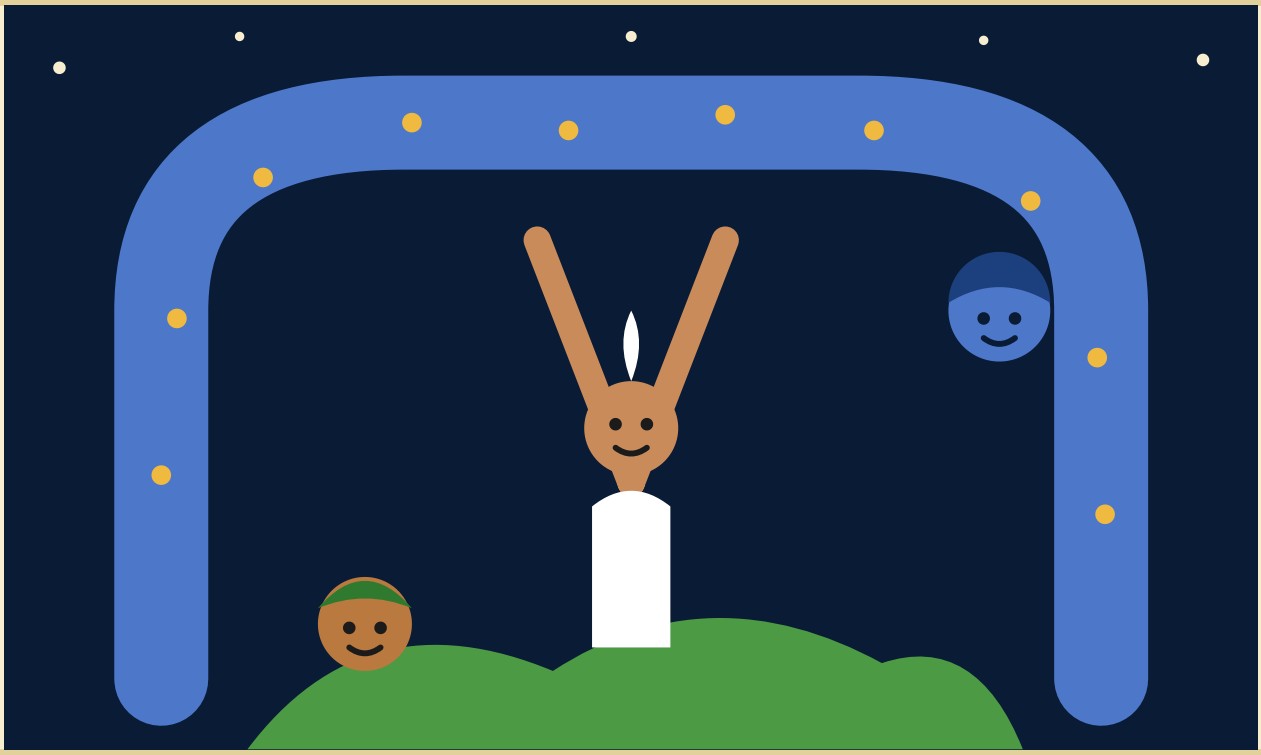
Every day, Ra sails his golden boat across the sky. That is why the sun moves from morning to evening.

At night, the boat goes under the earth. A giant snake called **Apep** tries to stop it. Ra and his friends push the snake away every single night.

And every morning, the sun comes up again!

> **TALK ABOUT IT**
> **Where does the sun go at night in this story?**

# 2 The Sky, the Earth and Five Extra Days



**Nut** was the sky. **Geb** was the earth. They loved each other and hugged very tight. But there was no room for anything to live!

So their father **Shu**, the god of air, lifted Nut high up. Now she bends over the earth, and the stars shine on her body.

Nut wanted children. But Ra said, "No babies on any day of the year." Back then a year had 360 days.

Clever **Thoth** had an idea. He played a board game with the Moon and won some moonlight. He used it to make **five extra days**.

On those new days Nut had her children. Four of them were **Osiris, Isis, Set** and **Nephthys**. And now a year has 365 days.

TALK ABOUT IT

**How did Thoth solve the problem without fighting?**

# 3 Isis Finds Osiris



**Osiris** was a kind king. He taught people to grow food. His wife was **Isis**, who knew strong magic.

His brother **Set** was jealous. He wanted to be king. So Set played a mean trick. He shut Osiris inside a beautiful box and pushed it into the river Nile.

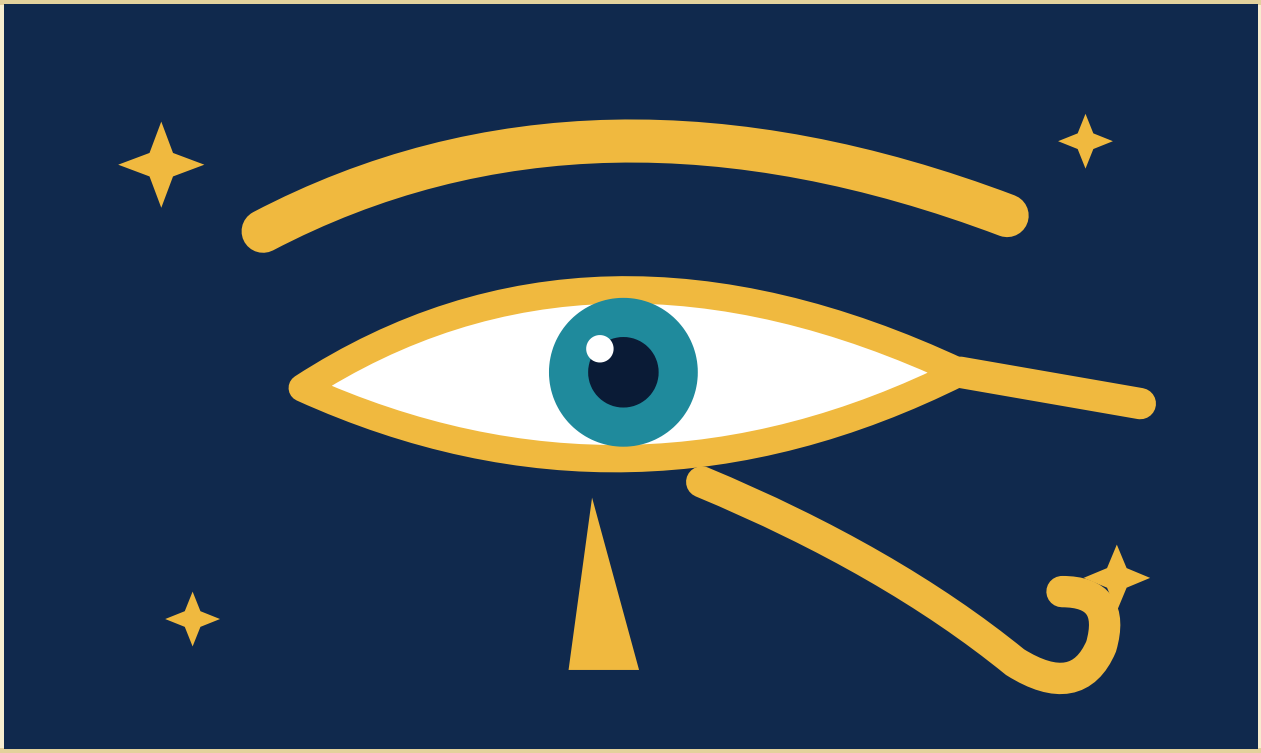
Isis was very sad, but she did not give up. She looked everywhere. She even turned into a bird to fly and search.

At last she found Osiris. Her love and magic woke him. Osiris became the gentle king of the land of spirits, far under the earth.

TALK ABOUT IT

**Isis did not give up. When did you keep trying at something hard?**

# 4 Horus and the Magic Eye



Isis and Osiris had a son called **Horus**. He had the head of a falcon, a bird that flies very high.

When Horus grew up, he said, "My father was the king. Now it is my turn." But his uncle **Set** said, "No! I am the king."

They had many contests. In one of them, Set hurt Horus's eye. Wise **Thoth** fixed the eye with magic and made it as good as new.

The gods all agreed that Horus was right. Horus became king of Egypt. People drew his eye to keep them safe and well.

TALK ABOUT IT

**Can you draw the Eye of Horus?**

# 5 The Heart and the Feather



The Egyptians believed that after a long, long life, every person went on a trip to meet King **Osiris**.

**Anubis**, the god with a jackal head, held their hand so they were not afraid. He led them to a big golden scale.

On one side went the person's heart. On the other side went the feather of **Ma'at**, the goddess of truth. **Thoth** wrote down what happened.

If you were kind and told the truth, your heart was as light as the feather. Then you could live in a happy place called the Field of Reeds.

TALK ABOUT IT

**What kind things make a heart feel light?**